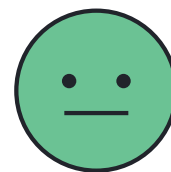
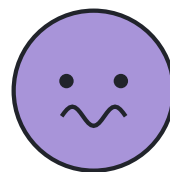
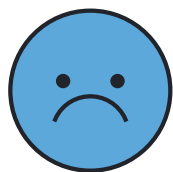




TEEN WELLBEING SEL SERIES



Grounded

A Guided Teen Journal for Mood, Stress & Self-Awareness

Written by Daniel Tesfamariam

Ages 10-19 - Printable

Home - Classroom - Counseling - Calm Corners

Reproducible for one home or classroom



How to Use This Book

This workbook is made for ages 10 to 19 - a stage packed with change, pressure, and big emotions. It won't talk down to you. Instead, it gives you real tools, honest questions, and space to think for yourself.

There are no grades and no wrong answers. Work at your own pace, be honest in the writing spaces, and come back to the pages that help most. Skills grow with practice.

For Grown-Ups

- ☐ Give privacy - journaling is more honest when it isn't graded or read without permission.
- ☐ Offer to talk, but don't force it; being available matters more than pushing.
- ☐ Model the skills yourself - teens notice what adults actually do.
- ☐ If big feelings feel unmanageable, connect the teen with a counselor or trusted professional.

Tip: There are no wrong answers here. Every feeling is okay. What matters is what we choose to DO with big feelings.



How This Book Works

Each part mixes three things: short explanations of what's going on in your brain and body, self-checks to notice your own patterns, and tools plus reflection to help you respond in ways you feel good about.

Getting the most from it

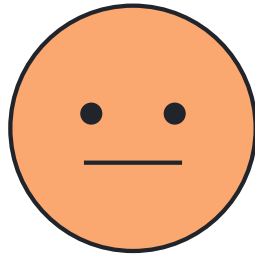
- ☐ Be honest - this is for you, not for show.
- ☐ Try the tools more than once before deciding if they help.
- ☐ Use the trackers to spot patterns over a week or two.
- ☐ Revisit the plans and update them as you learn.

This activity book supports everyday social-emotional learning and self-reflection. It is not therapy or medical advice. If you are struggling with your safety or mental health, please talk to a trusted adult, a counselor, or a local helpline right away.

What's Inside



- 1 How to Use This Journal
- 2 Daily Check-Ins
- 3 Weekly Reflections
- 4 Feelings & Thoughts
- 5 Growth & Gratitude
- 6 My Plan



Part 1: Getting Started

Journaling makes the invisible visible.



Why Journaling Helps

Writing about your thoughts and feelings sounds simple, but research shows it can lower stress, improve mood, and help you understand yourself better. Getting a worry out of your head and onto paper often shrinks it.

There's no right way to do this. Some days you'll write a lot, some days a line. Both count. This journal gives you gentle prompts so you're never staring at a blank page.

Journaling tips

- ☐ Be honest - no one is grading this.
- ☐ Don't worry about spelling or 'sounding deep.'
- ☐ Even a few minutes helps.
- ☐ Notice patterns over days and weeks.

Weekly Mood & Energy Tracker



Tracking your mood helps you spot patterns - what lifts you up and what drains you. Each day, shade your mood level (1 low - 5 high) and note one thing that affected it.

	1	2	3	4	5	What affected it?
Mon						
Tue						
Wed						
Thu						
Fri						
Sat						
Sun						



Part 2: Daily Check-Ins

A few minutes a day builds self-awareness.

Daily Check-In #1



Today my mood was... (and why)

One thing that challenged me

One thing that went okay or well

One thing I'll try tomorrow

Daily Check-In #2



Today my mood was... (and why)

One thing that challenged me

One thing that went okay or well

One thing I'll try tomorrow

Daily Check-In #3

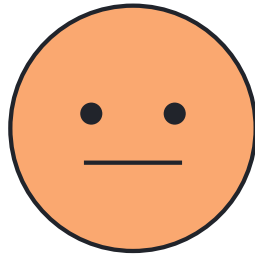


Today my mood was... (and why)

One thing that challenged me

One thing that went okay or well

One thing I'll try tomorrow



Part 3: Weekly Reflections

Zoom out and spot the patterns.

Weekly Reflection #1



What was the highlight and the hardest part of my week?

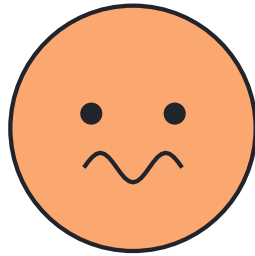
What drained my energy, and what refilled it?

Weekly Reflection #2



What was the highlight and the hardest part of my week?

What drained my energy, and what refilled it?



Part 4: Feelings & Thoughts

Understand what's going on inside.



Common Thinking Traps

Everyone's brain falls into 'thinking traps' sometimes. Naming them helps you step back. Circle the ones you notice most, then write an example.

All-or-nothing

Seeing things as total success or total failure, no middle ground.

Catastrophizing

Assuming the worst possible outcome will happen.

Mind-reading

Believing you know others are judging you - without proof.

Labeling

Calling yourself 'stupid' or 'a failure' over one event.

A thinking trap I fall into, and a real example:

Filtering

Only noticing the negatives and ignoring the positives.

Should statements

Harsh rules like 'I should always...' that set you up to feel bad.



Catch It, Check It, Change It

Our thoughts shape our feelings. Sometimes an automatic thought is unhelpful or untrue. You can CATCH the thought, CHECK if it's fair and true, and CHANGE it into a more balanced one. This is a skill - it gets easier with practice.

1. The situation (just the facts):

2. The automatic thought that popped up:

3. The feeling it gave me (and how strong, 0-10):

4. Check it: Is it 100% true? What's the evidence? Am I mind-reading or catastrophizing?

5. A more balanced, fair thought:

6. How I feel now:



A Feeling I Want to Understand

Pick a feeling that keeps showing up. When does it appear?

What might it be trying to tell you?



Part 5: Growth & Gratitude

Notice how far you've come.



What I'm Grateful For

Noticing good things helps calm our minds and lift our mood. It doesn't erase hard feelings, but it reminds us that good things are here too.

Three good things about today

Someone I'm thankful for - and why

Draw something that makes you smile:

A large, empty rectangular box with rounded corners and a thin gray border, intended for drawing.



How I'm Changing

What's something you handle better now than a year ago?

What kind of person are you becoming - and want to become?

My Personal Wellbeing Plan



Pull it all together. This is your go-to plan when things get hard.

My early warning signs that a feeling is getting big:

My top 3 tools that actually work for me:

People I can reach out to (and how):

Kind, true things I can tell myself:

One habit that helps me feel steady:



When You Need More Help

Some feelings are too big to handle alone - and that's not weakness, it's human. Reaching out is a strong, smart move.

Reach out if...

- ☐ A feeling won't ease up for days, or keeps getting worse.
- ☐ You're avoiding things you used to enjoy.
- ☐ You have thoughts of hurting yourself or others.
- ☐ You just need someone to talk to - that's reason enough.

Who I can reach out to

If you ever feel unsafe or think about hurting yourself, tell a trusted adult now or contact a local emergency number or crisis/helpline in your country right away. You deserve support.



What Matters to Me

Knowing what matters to you makes decisions and hard days easier. When you act in line with your values, stress often makes more sense and feels more manageable.

Three values that matter most to me

One goal that fits those values

One small step I can take this week



Checking In With Myself

What's one thing I'm handling better than I used to?

What still feels hard, and what might help?



Saying It: Boundary Scripts

A boundary is a limit that protects your wellbeing. Boundaries can be kind AND firm. Practice wording so it's ready when you need it.

Saying no without over-explaining: "No thanks, that doesn't work for me." My version:

Asking for space: "I need some time to myself right now." My version:

Naming a limit online: "Please don't share that." My version:

Asking for what I need: "It would help me if..." My version:



A Letter to Future Me

Write a short letter to yourself six months from now.

What do you hope is different? What do you want to remember?



Good Things Worth Noticing

Noticing good things helps calm our minds and lift our mood. It doesn't erase hard feelings, but it reminds us that good things are here too.

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